

A giant recycled table brings thousands together

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How long can a dinner table be? In Bucharest, Romania, one stretched for 3.1 miles, or 4.99 kilometers!

About 20,000 people gathered for a **community** meal at the Uniting Table on September 12, 2026. It earned a Guinness World Record for the longest table made from **recycled** materials. **Recycled** materials have been used before and are put to use again.

The **nonprofit** group Bloom The World organized the event. A **nonprofit** works toward a cause instead of sharing profits with owners. This meal raised more than \$110,000 for Romania's first **psychiatric** hospital for children. Such a hospital provides specialist care for mental health and related needs.

The new hospital is planned to open in 2027. Children needing mental health care in Bucharest currently use an outdated building with crowded wards and little **privacy**.

Bloom also set this record in 2025, with a shorter table in Alba Iulia, Romania.

The latest table's journey is not finished. Bloom plans to recycle its materials again, turning them into **furniture** for children.

Word Treasure

community -- A group of people connected by a place or shared interests.

recycled -- Processed after use so the materials can be used again.

nonprofit -- An organization that works for a cause instead of sharing profits with owners.

psychiatric -- Related to medical care for mental health.

privacy -- Having personal space and keeping personal matters to yourself.

furniture -- Objects such as tables, chairs and beds.

Background you need

A nonprofit works toward a cause instead of sharing profits with owners.

A psychiatric hospital provides specialist care for mental health and related needs.

Break it down

Opens with the table's unusual length.

Describes the gathering and its world record.

Explains the organizer, fundraising and planned hospital.

Mentions Bloom's earlier record.

Ends with the plan to turn the materials into children's furniture.

Why it matters

The meal brought people together and raised money for children's care. The table's materials are also planned to become children's furniture.

Test what you remember

1. Where did people gather at the Uniting Table in 2026?

- ☐ (A) Rome, Italy
- ☐ (B) Alba Iulia, Romania
- ☐ (C) Bucharest, Romania
- ☐ (D) Paris, France

2. How long was the table at the 2026 meal?

- ☐ (A) About 2.1 miles
- ☐ (B) About 4.1 miles
- ☐ (C) About 1.1 miles
- ☐ (D) About 3.1 miles

3. What did the meal raise money for?

- ☐ (A) A new children's library
- ☐ (B) A new children's theater
- ☐ (C) A new children's hospital
- ☐ (D) A new children's museum

4. When is the new hospital planned to open?

- ☐ (A) In 2027
- ☐ (B) In 2025
- ☐ (C) In 2026
- ☐ (D) In 2028

5. According to the article, what does a nonprofit work toward?

- ☐ (A) Sharing profits with owners
- ☐ (B) Selling shares to owners
- ☐ (C) Supporting a cause
- ☐ (D) Paying profits to investors

6. What does Bloom plan to make from the table's materials?

- ☐ (A) Shelters for animals
- ☐ (B) Equipment for cooks
- ☐ (C) Benches for parks
- ☐ (D) Furniture for children

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: D 3: C 4: A 5: C 6: D

Questions to think about

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):